

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 15, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m8a-9t8f-kmjf
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: API

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001

Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479

Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-1831

Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

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General Comment

As a professional in the manufacturing industry whose job is to stay abreast of technology, one thing is clear to me: AI is not a technology - it's a marketing term.

The variety of technologies that have been arbitrarily pushed under the umbrella of AI range from voice-to-text apps using 10-year-old technology to advanced software that aids in product design or programming. In evaluating these technologies, a clear pattern has emerged in which technologies with narrow focuses (such as predictive maintenance) can be incredibly useful while technologies with broad scopes (chat bots like ChatGPT and Gemini) are absolutely useless.

OpenAI promises its technology can do anything because after billions in investments they have created a neat toy that can't really do anything. Can it write a compelling story? No, readers quickly identify AI stories and feel near universal disdain. Can it do math? No, it's far worse than a 30-year-old calculator at math. Frankly, it's far worse than most Americans at math. What about as a search engine? Recent studies have shown that they are more likely to produce incorrect results than correct ones, confidently hallucinating lies that fool the gullible.

OpenAI began calling its little chatbot an artificial intelligence to evoke the romance of fictional stories, but the reality is that if you need to put something in writing and don't care about the quality, ChatGPT will likely produce something passable with only a handful of major errors. Calling it an AI seemed like a better pitch.

While other technologies that have fallen under the AI umbrella as of late can regularly demonstrate real value to various industries, LLMs like ChatGPT have shown nothing of real value to the economy. They have, however, shown the potential to harm industries that are vital for America's economic dominance.

Copyright law in the United States has a single clear purpose: encouraging people to make art that can make money. Multiple billion-dollar industries have erupted from the robust copyright protections the U.S. offers. If you make something, you get to decide how it's distributed, and people need to pay you to distribute or consume your art. It's a simple premise that forms the foundation of dozens of corporations and millions of careers. Attacking that foundation risks the livelihoods of millions, but Open AI believes it is entitled to the unpaid labor of all of humanity because it is necessary to... let you write an email in slightly less time? If you happen to be bad at writing emails. It can also produce a bad essay if you want to cheat on your homework and get caught, I suppose.

The simple fact is that LLMs cannot be depended on in producing anything that depends on accuracy. Legal briefs, instructions, articles, memos, captions, notes... none of these can depend on LLMs. In fact, the nature of how LLMs are "trained" makes it impossible for them to ever be relied on for accuracy. When it comes to art, LLMs steal work belonging to companies and individuals and produce writing that the public at large consistently despises. Allowing them a free pass to ignore copyright law will endanger the incredibly profitable creative industries to flood the market with garbage that no one wants, making us less competitive overall.

OpenAI, Meta, and Google have consistently demonstrated that their AIs offer little that anyone wants, and their insistence on their strategic importance to the nation is laughable. Actual AI technology has already been providing real benefits to industry and will continue to do so without OpenAI's ridiculous boondoggle undermining the competitiveness of America's creative industries.

